Editor Guide

Copernicus Land Monitoring Service - Technical Library

Author: **European Environment Agency (EEA)**

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> ℹ Note
>
> This guide assumes your project is already integrated with the Technical Library - the `DOCS/` subtree is in place and the Git aliases are configured. If that setup isn't done yet, see the **Setup Guide** first.

1. How This Works

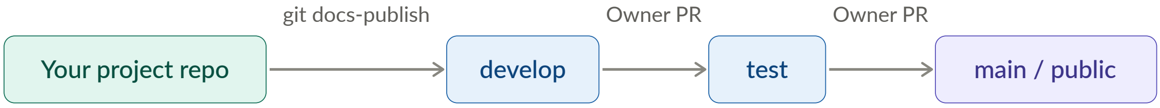
1.1 Your project and the central library

Your project repository contains a `DOCS/` folder that is both part of your project and part of the central CLMS Technical Library. The connection works as a **git subtree**: your documents live in your repo, but `git docs-publish` merges them into the library's `develop` branch.

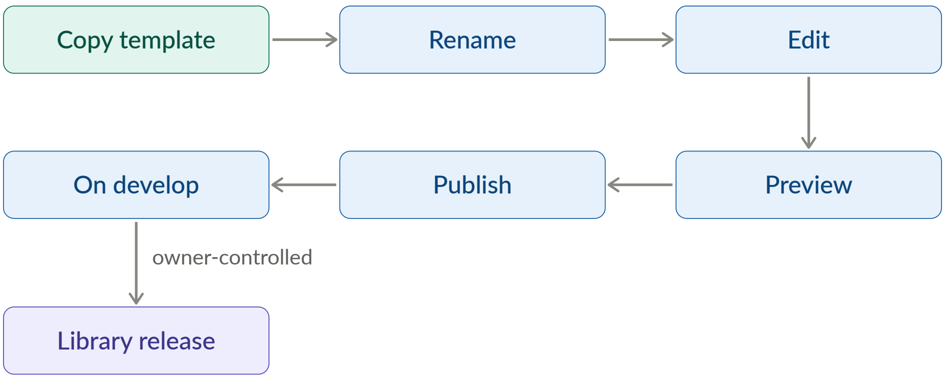
That means you own the source. You edit locally, commit to your project, and publish when ready. The library pulls in documents from all projects.

1.2 The publish flow

Publishing to `develop` is not a public release. The public-facing library only changes when a Technical Library owner promotes changes from `develop` to `test` to `main`. As an editor, your work stops at `develop`.



1.3 The document lifecycle



Major version bumps are your decision - you create a new file with a bumped `_v<N>` suffix. Minor and patch versions are AI-assigned at release time based on the scope of changes.

2. Starting a New Document

2.1 From a template (recommended)

Pick the template that matches your document type:

- `CLMS_Template_ATBD.qmd` - Algorithm Theoretical Basis Document, for the scientific and technical foundations of a data product
- `CLMS_Template_PUM.qmd` - Product User Manual, for how users access and interpret a product

Once you've chosen:

1. Copy the template into `DOCS/` (not sure what that looks like? See **Folder and File Structure**)
2. Rename it using this pattern: `CLMS_<Product-Name>_<Document-Type>_v<Major-Version>.qmd`

   For example: `CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v1.qmd`

   Use hyphens within the product name, not underscores. Start every new document at `_v1`. The document type is either `ATBD` or `PUM`.
3. Create a matching `-media/` folder for images: `CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v1-media/`
4. Edit in place, following the structure the template provides

The templates include a pre-filled YAML header, required sections, and commented guidance throughout. Try to keep the structure intact - it makes a real difference to how consistently documents behave across the library.

2.2 From scratch

If neither template fits, create a new `.qmd` file directly in `DOCS/`, following the same naming pattern, create a matching `-media/` folder, and add the required YAML header manually (see **The YAML Header**).

> Tip
>
> Templates save time even when they don't feel like an exact fit - the YAML header and section structure are the main things you'd otherwise need to set up manually.

Migrating an existing `.docx`? See the Migration Guide [TBD link].

3. The YAML Header

If you copied a template, the header is pre-filled - just update `title`, `subtitle`, `date`, and `product-name`.

3.1 Required fields

```yaml
---
title: "HRL Forest"
subtitle: "High Resolution Layer - Forest Type"
date: "2026-01-27"
product-name: "HRL Forest"
---
```

- `title` - short product name, appears as the document title

- `subtitle` - full product name or document type description
- `date` - publication or last-updated date in ISO format
- `product-name` - used internally for metadata and indexing

3.2 Optional fields

- `template-version` - records which template version was used as the starting point. Set automatically when copying a template; don't edit it manually.

3.3 System-managed fields

Leave these out of your YAML header entirely - the publishing system handles them:

- `keywords` - AI-generated at publish time based on document content. Anything you add gets overwritten.
- `version` - carried by the filename suffix, not the YAML. No version field belongs in the header.

4. Writing Content

Markdown basics - headings, lists, links, images, tables, equations, footnotes, diagrams - are covered in the Quarto Markdown guide. This chapter covers only what's specific to this system.

4.1 Image folder convention

Images go in <your-document-name>-media/, referenced with relative paths:

```
![Processing workflow](CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2-media/workflow.png)
```

4.2 Page breaks

Use the Quarto shortcode to insert a page break in PDF output:

```
{{< pagebreak >}}
```

Note that `---` renders as a horizontal rule, not a page break.

4.3 Complex table layouts

For tables with merged cells, nested content, or custom styling, use HTML tables directly in your `.qmd` file. Both the HTML output and Typst-rendered PDF handle them well.

Standard Markdown tables have limited formatting options. HTML tables let you control exactly how things look - column widths, cell colours, text alignment, borders - using inline CSS:

````
```{=html}
<table style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;">
  <thead>
    <tr style="background-color: #2c3e50; color: white;">
      <th colspan="2" style="padding: 10px; text-align: center;">Product Overview</th>
    </tr>
  </thead>
  <tbody>
````
````

````
    <tr>
      <td style="padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ccc; font-weight: bold;">HRL Forest</td>
      <td style="padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ccc;">Active</td>
    </tr>
    <tr style="background-color: #f2f2f2;">
      <td style="padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ccc; font-weight: bold;">Water Bodies</td>
      <td style="padding: 8px; border: 1px solid #ccc;">Active</td>
    </tr>
  </tbody>
</table>
```
````

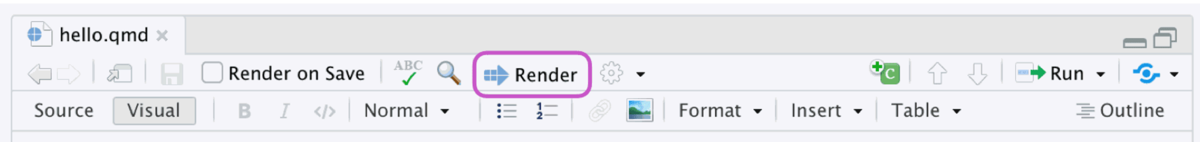
5. Editing and Previewing Locally

5.1 Open the project in RStudio

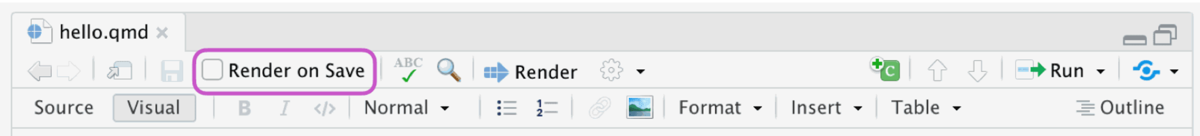
1. Open RStudio
2. **File > Open Project...** and select the root folder of your project
3. Navigate to `DOCS/` and open the `.qmd` file you want to edit

5.2 Preview your document

Click the **Render** button at the top of the editor pane to render HTML or PDF:

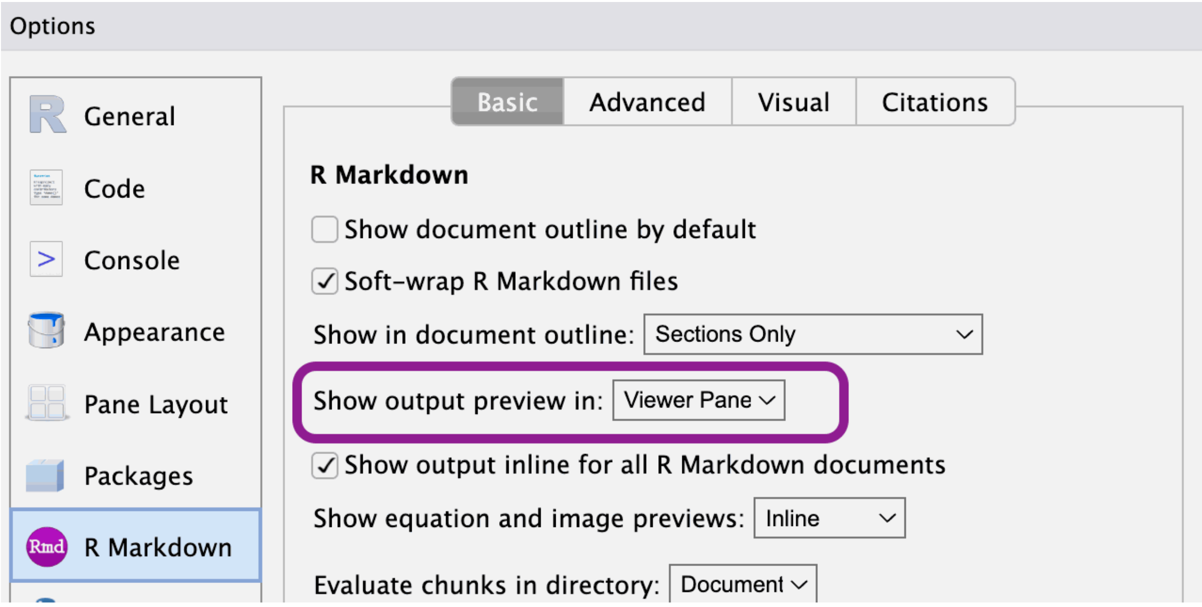


Or enable **Preview on Save** in the toolbar to re-render on every save:



The rendered output appears in the **Viewer** tab in the lower-right pane:

If the Viewer tab isn't showing rendered output, go to **Tools** > **Global Options** > **R Markdown** and set **Show output preview in** to **Viewer Pane**:
````



5.3 Render the full project

To render all documents and preview the complete library locally:

```
git docs-preview
```

> **Tip**
>
> The repository ships with the project config renamed to `_quarto-not-used.yaml` so RStudio operates in single-file mode by default - faster for day-to-day editing. When you need to render the full project, rename it to `_quarto.yaml`, run `quarto render`, then rename it back.

6. Publishing to Develop

```
git add DOCS/
git commit -m "docs: update [brief description]"
git docs-publish
```

After the pipeline runs, check your document at: https://eea.github.io/CLMS_documents/develop/index.html

Navigation, cross-links, and the sidebar TOC can behave differently than in your local RStudio preview - worth a quick look before calling it done.

7. Folder and File Structure

```
DOCS/
├── _meta/                        # Scripts, config, metadata - do not edit
├── includes/                     # Quarto include files - do not edit
```

```
├── templates/                      # Document templates - do not edit
├── theme/                          # Styling definitions - do not edit
├── _quarto.yml                     # Project-wide Quarto config
├── CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd
├── CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2-media/
├── CLMS_Water-Bodies_ATBD_v1.qmd
├── CLMS_Water-Bodies_ATBD_v1-media/
└── ...
```

Your work lives in `DOCS/` directly: one `.qmd` file per document, plus a matching `-media/` folder for images and diagrams. The four managed subdirectories (`_meta/`, `includes/`, `templates/`, `theme/`) are updated centrally - don't edit them.

8. File Naming and Versioning

8.1 The version suffix

The `_v<N>` suffix in the filename is the major version - the only version number you control. Minor and patch versions are assigned automatically by AI at library release time based on the scope of changes: small corrections get a patch bump (`2.3.5 → 2.3.6`), new or revised sections get a minor bump (`2.3.0 → 2.4.0`). A new file `CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v3.qmd` starts at `3.0.0` at its first release. You never set a version number in YAML.

8.2 When to create a new major version

Edit the existing file for most changes. Create a new major version only when you need to:

- rewrite most of the content
- make breaking structural changes
- keep the previous version available as a stable reference

```
cp DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v3.qmd
cp -r DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2-media DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v3-media
```

Both versions stay in the library and evolve independently from that point on.

8.3 Don't rename after publishing

The filename becomes part of the document's URL. Renaming breaks links and cross-references. If a significant revision is needed, create a new major version rather than renaming.

9. Restoring Previous Versions

Restore pulls a published version of a document into your local working copy. It doesn't roll back the library - think of it as "pick up from version X," not "undo to version X."

9.1 Commands

```
git docs-restore --list-all                           # all published documents
git docs-restore --list DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd     # versions of one file
```

```
git docs-restore DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd 2.0.0      # specific version
git docs-restore --latest DOCS/CLMS_HRL-Forest_PUM_v2.qmd   # latest published version
```

9.2 When to use it

Recover deleted content. You removed a section locally and need it back. Restore the last published version, copy out what you need, then carry on with your current version.

Something went wrong in a recent edit. Restore an earlier version (e.g. `2.1.0`) and work forward from there rather than trying to untangle the current state.

Resurrect a deleted file. If a file was removed from the project but still exists in the library history, `--list-all` will find it. Restore brings it back into `DOCS/` as if nothing happened.

10. Release Path

Once you publish to `develop`, the rest of the process belongs to Technical Library owners. Getting from develop to public requires two separate pull requests, each reviewed and approved by a second owner before it merges.

Stage	URL
develop	https://eea.github.io/CLMS_documents/develop/index.html
test	https://eea.github.io/CLMS_documents/test/index.html
main (public)	https://library.land.copernicus.eu

At each release, the system assigns version numbers automatically based on what changed.

11. Change Log

Date	Version	Summary
2025-12-03	1.0.0	Initial release